

# POWERFUL BUT **AFFORDABLE LAPTOPS** UNDER ₹ 25,000

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**S**martphones and tablets have become more prominent than laptops and PCs in the last five to six years. People can now do a lot more on mobile devices, including watching movies and small chunks of official work. In spite of this, working professionals and students cannot ignore the importance of laptops and PCs. Specialised work, such as software coding and hardware programming, design and layout, sound testing and so on, cannot be done on cellphones or tablets. Even the experience of watching a movie is better on a laptop or another large screen as compared to a mobile device.

However, prices of laptops are still a bit high if you want decent specifications. This is because major laptop companies still have no plans of manufacturing the devices in India, and high custom duties (import taxes) make the prices go up even higher. This ultimately poses a problem for those who cannot afford to pay more than ₹ 25,000 for a laptop. In this article, we have compiled a list of laptops in this price segment, which will allow users to carry out all basic work and even watch HD/Blu-ray movies.

## Specifications to consider

Some important features and specifications to consider while buying a budget laptop are discussed next.

**Keypad quality.** Keypad is one of the most important parts of the laptop. Laptop keypad is not as sturdy as the general PC keyboard and is sometimes of poor quality. There are many high-end laptops that come with inferior-quality keyboard. For long and fast typing, the keypad must have tough finish.

Sometimes, keys break or get separated from the pad. It is imperative to check the strength, smoothness and comfort of the keypad.

These days companies are offering backlit keypads even on budget laptops so that users can type even in low light.

**High-resolution display.** There was a time when laptops were available with a display resolution of 1366 × 768 pixels, even expensive models. This not only provided poor picture quality, at the same time text did not fit properly on the screen. And, users had to scroll down to edit and read Web pages. Now, budget laptops are also available with a display resolution of 1920 × 1080 pixels.

With the rise of OTT players, videos are available in HD and Blu-ray quality, and to experience great picture quality, the display must be equipped with this resolution.

**Battery.** Battery is another major requirement to look at. There are various elements that affect the longevity/power backup life of the battery, including screen resolution, brightness, applications that run in the background, and total time the device is connected to Wi-Fi and Bluetooth. Hence, battery manufacturers have come up with batteries that provide at least eight hours of backup.

**CPU and RAM.** Nowadays, there are semiconductor companies that offer extremely poor-quality processors in mid-range laptops and mobile devices. If you are a layman and do not have much knowledge about the core features of laptops, you should opt for Intel Core-based CPUs, which have gained huge traction among consumers for decades.

AMD also offers good processors. Even, Ryzen Mobile CPUs are usually paired with AMD's Vega graphics chipsets, which are now the most loved in the gaming platform segment, rather than Intel's own chipsets.

Another important criterion is RAM. For laptops under ₹ 25,000 you will mostly find maximum 4GB DDR3 RAM. Never go for RAM below 4GB now because if the processor is average, RAM must at least be good. Some companies now offer DDR4 series under special schemes.

**Security.** With the emergence and popularity of digital payments and Internet browsing, security of your device is under greater threat. Before buying a laptop, ensure that it comes with total security option.

Apart from passwords, laptops now have additional security features such as fingerprint scanner and face lock/unlock. The laptop should also provide good Internet security solution.

## Market options

Some popular options available in the market are given below.

**HP APU Dual Core A9 7th gen.** Its 39.6cm (15.6-inch) BrightView HD screen is ideal for browsing the Internet, watching videos and images, and for video-chatting with family and friends. This laptop comes with HP's